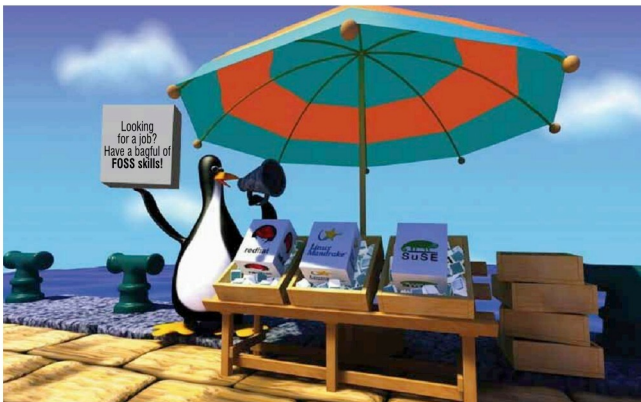


The Top Open Source Skills that Will Get You Hired this Year!

Despite the continuing economic downturn, the IT job landscape is expected to be rather buoyant for open source professionals in 2013.



Open source technology, undoubtedly, has navigated its way through the choppy waters of the global recession and emerged a key driver of IT growth. There is a surge in the number of companies continuing with open source technology adoption. And this trend will translate into more jobs for FOSS professionals in the days to come. According to the 2013 Salary Guide released by the US consulting firm Robert Half International, this year, some of the rewarding jobs will go to those with a fundamental understanding of Linux and open source. With the job market looking upbeat for FOSS experts, we spoke to industry leaders about the top open source skills that will be in demand this year.

Industry stalwarts believe that the next couple of years will see Big Data and cloud computing skills featuring high on the wish list of recruiters. A recent poll conducted by the OSFY team on its Facebook page also indicates that cloud computing is being touted as the hottest skill in 2013. Lux Rao, country lead, Cloud Consulting at HP, India, shares, "There will be a tremendous

amount of interest around Big Data and cloud computing skills this year as both of them are changing the way enterprises function. With data analytics gaining momentum and being acknowledged as an important key to business growth, there will be an emerging requirement for data scientists. Also, 2013 will see a mass adoption of the cloud by companies in India. Most organisations use an open source cloud distribution, such as OpenStack or CloudStack, so hiring individuals with expertise in the open source domain will definitely be a priority."

Echoing similar views, Srihari Srinivasan, head of technology at Thoughtworks, India, states, "Some significant skills based on OSS that will continue to gain traction include the ability to create solutions based on Hadoop and the components of its ecosystem, and the ability to implement private clouds based on 'Infrastructure as a Service' solutions such as OpenStack and CloudStack. Today, it's really hard to imagine an enterprise not consuming OSS in one way or the other since people are no longer paranoid about using OSS on their critical systems."